

Rhentify — Site Review & Growth Guide

Website: <https://rhentify.com>

Prepared: June 2026

Purpose: Actionable improvements to fix trust issues, improve UX, and grow early users.

Download (after deploy): <https://rhentify.com/docs/rhentify-improvement-guide.pdf>

In-app: Resources page → "Download PDF"

Executive summary

Rhentify has a **polished landing page** and a **solid product foundation** — local rentals plus hiring, zero platform fees, and clear messaging ("Rent what you need / Hire who you trust").

The main blocker is not design — it is marketplace liquidity. At review time there were only a handful of listings, concentrated in Budapest, mostly from one owner. The rent-requests feed was empty. That creates a "ghost town" feeling even when the UI looks professional.

The playbook that works: Win one neighborhood first → supply → local demand → first happy transactions → word of mouth → expand cities.

Part 1 — Critical issues (fix first)

These hurt trust and conversion immediately.

Issue	What was observed	Why it matters
Homepage shows no listings	Homepage said "No listings available yet" while /search had real listings	First-time visitors think the site is empty
Dashboard stuck loading	/dashboard showed a spinner for logged-out users	Dead-end instead of a clean redirect to login
Broken forgot password	Login linked to /forgot-password but page did not exist	Broken flow erodes trust
Placeholder contact info	support@rentify.com, fake phone, San Francisco address	Looks like an unfinished template
Empty resources page	Cards with no real content or links	Hurts owner onboarding
Generic social links	Footer pointed to facebook.com, twitter.com, etc.	No real brand presence
Reviews inconsistency	Search cards showed ratings but detail page sometimes said "No reviews yet"	Undermines trust

Status: Many of these have been addressed in code (see Part 5). Remaining items need ongoing content and supply-side work.

Part 2 — UX & product improvements

2.1 Mobile experience

- On mobile, the **filter panel covered most of the screen** before users saw listings.
- Form label contrast was weak (light text on light backgrounds).

Recommendations:

- Show listings first; collapse filters behind a clear “Filters” button.
- Improve form label contrast for accessibility (WCAG).

2.2 Geographic and currency clarity

- All inventory was in **Budapest (HUF)**, but the homepage used “**\$0 booking fees**” and felt globally generic.

Recommendations:

- Use launch messaging: *“Now live in Budapest — expanding soon.”*
- Add location detection or a city picker so visitors know if Rhentify is relevant.
- Show local currency (HUF / Ft) consistently on the homepage.

2.3 Onboarding after signup

After “Get started,” users had no guided path.

Recommendations:

- Post-signup wizard on the dashboard:
 - **“I want to rent”** → browse by category
 - **“I want to earn”** → create first listing in 3 steps
- Show one clear next action, not a blank dashboard.

2.4 Listing quality

- Some listings were miscategorized (e.g. vacuum under Electronics).
- Descriptions had typos and inconsistent formatting.

Recommendations:

- Listing creation tips: good photos, correct category, clear pricing, pickup details.
- Optional checklist before publish (“Add at least 2 photos”, “Set a daily rate”).

2.5 Trust page accuracy

Safety page claimed **“All users go through identity verification”** and **“24/7 support”** while KYC was optional and support looked placeholder.

Recommendations:

- Only claim what is actually live.
- Honest trust beats overpromising.

2.6 Register page copy

“Join thousands of renters and owners” was misleading with very few listings.

Recommendations:

- Use early-stage copy: *“Be an early member in Budapest.”*

2.7 SEO and sharing

- All pages shared one generic title.
- No strong local SEO or Open Graph images.

Recommendations:

- Per-page metadata and Open Graph tags.
 - City-specific landing pages (e.g. `/budapest` , `/camera-rental-budapest`).
 - Blog or guide content for local search ("rent camera Budapest").
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Part 3 — What is already working well

- Strong homepage hero — search bar, "List something you own", "No platform fees"
 - **Rent requests feed** — smart cold-start feature (demand before supply)
 - Listing detail page — pricing tiers, deposit, date picker, "Request to Book"
 - Broad categories — tools, vehicles, services, housing, etc.
 - Auth options — email + Google sign-in
 - Dark mode and modern visual design
 - In-app messaging and booking flow structure
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Part 4 — How to get people to start using Rhentify

Marketplaces fail when they try to be everywhere at once. **Win one neighborhood first.**

Phase 1: Supply (weeks 1–4) — target 30–50 real listings

You need inventory before marketing to renters.

1. **Hyperfocus on Budapest** — every listing, ad, and post should say "Budapest" explicitly.
2. **Recruit "anchor" owners manually** — people who already rent informally:
 - Photographers / videographers
 - DJs, event planners
 - DIY / tool owners
 - Students with dorm furniture
 - Freelancers offering services
3. **Founding-owner incentive:**
 - Featured placement for 90 days
 - \$0 fees forever for first 50 owners
 - Help photograph and write listings
4. **Seed listings** — partner with 5–10 real people; one owner with 4 items is not enough variety.

Phase 2: Demand (weeks 2–6) — create reasons to visit weekly

1. **Push the Rent Requests feed** — *"Need something? Post a request — owners reply in 24 hours."*
 - Facebook groups, university pages, local subreddits
2. **Go where renters already are:**
 - Budapest expat / student Facebook groups
 - University noticeboards
 - Local sharing / "buy nothing" communities
 - Instagram / TikTok: "Stop buying a drill you'll use once"
3. **Use-case marketing, not generic ads:**
 - "Rent a pro camera for the weekend — HUF 150/day"

- "Need a civil engineer for a small project?"
- "Moving? Rent a vacuum for 3 days"

4. Referral loop:

- Renter refers owner → featured listing boost
- Owner refers renter → small discount on first booking

Phase 3: Conversion (ongoing) — remove friction

1. Let visitors **browse without signing up**; require login only at "Request to Book".
2. **Homepage must show real listings** — fixing the empty featured section improves bounce rate.
3. **Email capture** for non-Budapest visitors: "Get notified when we launch in your city."
4. **First-booking nudge** after signup: "Here are 3 items near you this week."
5. **Owner success content** in Resources:
 - How to price your item
 - How to take listing photos
 - How deposits work

Phase 4: Trust (parallel)

- Real support email: `support@rhentify.com`
- Show verified badges only when KYC is completed
- Display "X listings in Budapest" on the homepage
- Add 2–3 short testimonials after first real bookings
- Respond fast to every booking request (speed builds word of mouth early)

Part 5 — 30-day action plan

Week	Focus	Goal
1	Fix bugs + trust	Homepage shows listings, dashboard redirects properly, real contact info
2	Supply blitz	20+ listings from 10+ different owners in Budapest
3	Demand	Post in 5 local communities; get 10+ rent requests on /feed
4	First transactions	Personally facilitate 3–5 bookings end-to-end

Part 6 — Highest-impact quick wins (priority order)

1. Fix homepage featured listings so existing inventory appears
2. Add "**Now in Budapest**" to hero and metadata
3. Replace placeholder contact / support info
4. Build forgot-password flow (frontend + backend + email)
5. Add post-signup onboarding on dashboard ("Browse" vs "List an item")
6. Personally recruit **10 owners** before spending on ads

Part 7 — Technical implementation notes (completed in codebase)

The following were implemented in the project repository for deploy:

- **Hero** — Budapest badge, improved copy, search defaults to Budapest

- **FeaturedListings** — loading state, Budapest-first fetch with fallback, `ListingCard` reuse
- **Dashboard** — auth redirect fix + `DashboardOnboarding` component
- **Auth** — `/forgot-password` , `/reset-password` , backend reset endpoints
- **Contact** — `support@rhentify.com` , `mailto` form, Budapest launch info
- **Safety, About, Resources, Footer, Register** — honest copy and real links
- **SearchFilters** — collapsed by default on mobile
- **layout.tsx** — SEO / Open Graph metadata
- **next.config.js** — production S3 image domain

Deploy checklist

1. **Database:** ensure `users` table has `password_reset_token` and `password_reset_expires_at` (migration if `ddl-auto=validate` in production).
2. **Backend env:** `MAIL_*` , `FRONTEND_URL=https://rhentify.com` for password reset emails.
3. **Frontend env (optional):** `NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPPORT_EMAIL=support@rhentify.com` .
4. Redeploy frontend and backend together.

Part 8 — Bottom line

Rhentify does not need a full redesign — it needs **density in one city** and **a few trust fixes**. The product is ahead of the market: good UI, booking flow, rent-requests idea, and zero-fee hook.

Supply → local demand → first happy transactions → word of mouth → expand cities

Focus on Budapest until you have repeatable bookings, then clone the playbook in the next city.

Document generated for Rhentify. Revisit quarterly as inventory and user base grow.